

# THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



5775

**THE BLUE CARD** is a charitable organization aiding Holocaust survivors since 1934. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors and their descendants in this country, who still suffer from the aftereffects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust has deprived them of a family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agency. During the year 2013, the Blue Card made grants amounting to nearly \$1.9 million. This brings the grant total since the Blue Card's inception to \$25.5 million.

**THE BLUE CARD** mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be important to you, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

**THE BLUE CARD** has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years in order to remind them, throughout the year, that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

**PLEASE SEE** *the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.*

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

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**Front cover: Felix Nussbaum's 1941 painting The Camp Synagogue at St. Cyprien.**

**Back cover: Kristallnacht, a painting by Charlotte Salomon from the Jewish Historical Museum in Amsterdam.**

# THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5775 (2014-2015 C.E.)

ITS THEME:

## ARTISTS WHO PERISHED IN THE HOLOCAUST

Published by

**THE BLUE CARD, Inc.®**

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1934

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5775

## INTRODUCTION

We are all familiar with the horrific statistics of how many people died in the Holocaust: some 11 million, including 1 million children, and a total of 6 million Jews. The scale of the killing was so vast that it isn't possible to comprehend it all, or even to count the victims accurately.

What's more, these aggregates don't measure the tragedy of individual lives lost and ruined, the families displaced, and the diversion from productive pursuits. This is a case where the sum of the parts greatly exceeds the whole, as huge as the whole is.

As we all know, telling individual stories can be a powerful way to memorialize and help comprehend the past, and that's what we've tried to do in many past Blue Card calendars, over the more than 50 years they've been published.

In this year's Blue Card calendar we chronicle the lives and work of a handful of the many performers, musicians and visual artists who lost their lives in the Holocaust. Some were well known in their communities and within Europe, and others were less celebrated during their lifetimes — but all carried an artistic spark and the profound drive to express themselves through their art.

In reading these stories, there is a consistent pattern: early expression of talent, sometimes to the point of obsession, consistent devotion to art and the craft of creating art, and then having everything derailed by the advent of Nazism. In the cases of those portrayed here, that was followed by their untimely death.

In the 1920s and before, Jews lived in every country in Europe, in many places in large numbers. Art and expression were valued in Jewish homes, and Jews contributed disproportionately to the creative communities where they lived. In many cases, they formed close friendships with



Gentiles, and particularly in the case of music and theater, there were close collaborations which produced masterworks.

Art was often a battleground for the Nazis, for they well recognized the threat that free expression posed. They wanted art to be in service of their racial theories and to promote the glory of the state. Work that did not fall in that category, including most of what was produced by Jews, was labeled “degenerate.” Great efforts were made to prevent the display and performance of work that did not meet Nazi standards and to eliminate those who created it.

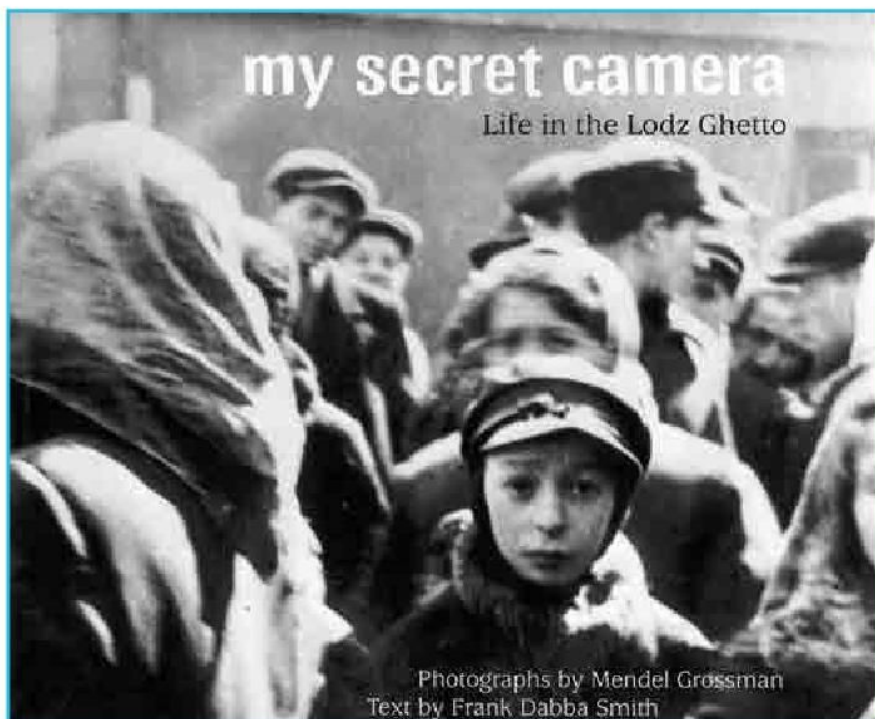
But art has a way of surviving obstacles put in its path, and that’s what we see in the portraits assembled in this calendar. Although much has been lost, much has been preserved to continue in the public eye. In many cases, vigorous efforts are still being made to locate lost work.

At the same time, it is impossible not to lament what might have been, to wonder what might have been created had those who were killed survived. It’s an unanswerable question, of course.

There is much to celebrate in the lives of those who were lost, and we hope you find the portraits in this calendar interesting.

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This year’s edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.



Mendel Grossman was born into a Polish Hasidic family. He began as a portrait artist, and then became a photographer, notably with theatrical troupes, using paint to hand-color his photos. In the Lodz Ghetto beginning in 1939, his official role was to take identification photographs, but he secretly devoted himself to chronicling life in the ghetto, taking tens of thousands of pictures. He died in 1945 on a forced march from the

labor camp where he was held. The photos that survived form an invaluable record of the lives of Jews in the ghetto. Grossman's photos are at Yad Vashem in Jerusalem and elsewhere in Israel, and a number have been collected in books.

| Elul 5774 - Tishri 5775 |                |         |                            | SEPTEMBER 2014                      |                                  |          |
|-------------------------|----------------|---------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------|
| SUNDAY                  | MONDAY         | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY                  | THURSDAY                            | FRIDAY                           | SATURDAY |
|                         | 1<br>Labor Day | 2       | 3                          | 4                                   | 5                                | 6        |
| 7                       | 8              | 9       | 10                         | 11                                  | 12                               | 13       |
| 14                      | 15             | 16      | 17                         | 18                                  | 19                               | 20       |
| 21                      | 22             | 23      | 24<br>Erev<br>Rosh Hashana | 25<br>Tishri 1 5775<br>Rosh Hashana | 26<br>Rosh Hashana<br>Second Day | 27       |
| 28                      | 29             | 30      |                            |                                     |                                  |          |



The multitalented Miklós Vig was born Miklós Vogelhut in Budapest. He performed as an actor and comedian, but achieved his greatest renown as a cabaret singer, becoming one of Hungary's most popular performers of the era. His light, pleasing tenor was well suited to operetta and popular song. He made many recordings, becoming one of Hungary's first recording stars, and a few of his songs have been posted on the Internet, at <http://bit.ly/miklosvig>, by one of his relatives. Vig was executed by members of the Arrow Cross party — Hungarian Nazis — who lined him up along the Danube and fired machine guns. Many other Jews suffered the same fate, and they are commemorated in the poignant "Shoes on the Danube Bank" memorial in Budapest.

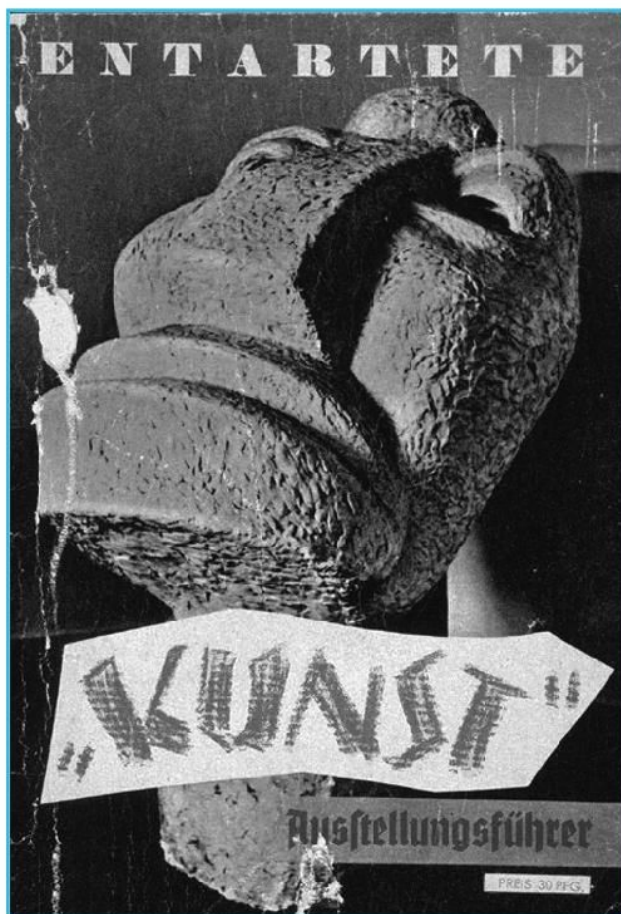


| Tishri - Heshvan 5775 |                    |         |                     | OCTOBER 2014          |                         |                 |
|-----------------------|--------------------|---------|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|
| SUNDAY                | MONDAY             | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY           | THURSDAY              | FRIDAY                  | SATURDAY        |
|                       |                    |         | 1                   | 2                     | 3<br>Erev<br>Yom Kippur | 4<br>Yom Kippur |
| 5                     | 6                  | 7       | 8                   | 9<br>Succoth 1st Day  | 10<br>Succoth 2nd Day   | 11              |
| 12                    | 13<br>Columbus Day | 14      | 15<br>Hoshana Rabba | 16<br>Shemini Atzeret | 17<br>Simchat Torah     | 18              |
| 19                    | 20                 | 21      | 22                  | 23                    | 24                      | 25<br>Heshvan 1 |
| 26                    | 27                 | 28      | 29                  | 30                    | 31                      |                 |



Bernard Natan's work was enormously important to the development of cinema. He was born in Romania with the name Natan Tannenzaft, and moved to Paris in his teens. He soon began working in film as a projectionist, developing film, and eventually as a cinematographer and producer. He became a movie mogul, acquiring the Pathé studio, producing scores of films, bringing sound to the French cinema, acquiring movie theaters and discovering actors including Jean Gabin. He created the first French television company and owned radio stations. When Pathé collapsed during the depression, Natan was imprisoned for fraud. After France fell to the Nazis, Natan was transferred to concentration camps, dying at Auschwitz in 1942.

| Heshvan - Kislev 5775 |        |               |           |              |        | NOVEMBER 2014 |
|-----------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------------|--------|---------------|
| SUNDAY                | MONDAY | TUESDAY       | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY     | FRIDAY | SATURDAY      |
|                       |        |               |           |              |        | 1             |
| 2                     | 3      | 4             | 5         | 6            | 7      | 8             |
| Daylight Time Ends    |        |               |           |              |        |               |
| 9                     | 10     | 11            | 12        | 13           | 14     | 15            |
|                       |        | Veteran's Day |           |              |        |               |
| 16                    | 17     | 18            | 19        | 20           | 21     | 22            |
| 23<br>Kislev 1        | 24     | 25            | 26        | 27           | 28     | 29            |
| 30                    |        |               |           | Thanksgiving |        |               |



Otto Freundlich was born in 1878 in the town of Stolp, which was then part of Pomerania and is now the Polish town of Słupsk. Although he studied dentistry, his interests gravitated more toward art, and he undertook art studies in Paris and Berlin in the first decade of the 20th century. His paintings were Cubist and abstract, and many of them consist of colorful geometric shapes.

His sculpture *The New Man* was included in the notorious 1937 exhibition of what the Nazis called “degenerate art,” and was on the cover of the exhibition catalog. The sculpture is lost and is presumed not to have survived World War II. His work can be seen today in the collections of many museums, including the Museum of Modern Art.

Freundlich spent the war years in France. He was detained in the Pyrenees in 1943 and deported to the Majdanek concentration camp, where he was killed.



| Kislev - Tevet 5775 |        |                                |                             | DECEMBER 2014       |        |          |
|---------------------|--------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY              | MONDAY | TUESDAY                        | WEDNESDAY                   | THURSDAY            | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                     | 1      | 2                              | 3                           | 4                   | 5      | 6        |
| 7                   | 8      | 9                              | 10                          | 11                  | 12     | 13       |
| 14                  | 15     | 16<br>Hanukkah<br>First Candle | 17<br>Hanukkah<br>First Day | 18                  | 19     | 20       |
| 21                  | 22     | 23<br>Tevet 1                  | 24<br>Hanukkah<br>8th Day   | 25<br>Christmas Day | 26     | 27       |
| 28                  | 29     | 30                             | 31<br>New Year's Eve        |                     |        |          |



The singer, actress and dancer Lisl Frank was born Alice Frankl in Prague. She met her husband, the actor and theatrical director Otto Aufrechtig, when they were both performing at a Czech theater. Together, they enjoyed great popular success at a succession of theaters and opera companies, first in Vienna, and after 1938, in the Netherlands. A song Lisl recorded in 1939, *Männer, Männer, Männer!*, survives today, collected on CD.

In 1943, the couple was deported to the Westerbork camp, where, remarkably, the inmates were allowed to form a theatrical troupe. Otto and Lisl participated in three shows there in 1944 — the programs for those shows are at <http://bit.ly/westerbork>. They were subsequently deported to Theresienstadt and then to Auschwitz. Lisl died in Christianstadt following a forced march. Otto survived the war and returned to Amsterdam, where he had a successful career in the theater.

| Tevet - Shevat 5775 |                                     |         |                | JANUARY 2015        |        |          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------|---------|----------------|---------------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY              | MONDAY                              | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY      | THURSDAY            | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                     |                                     |         |                | 1<br>New Year's Day | 2      | 3        |
| 4                   | 5                                   | 6       | 7              | 8                   | 9      | 10       |
| 11                  | 12                                  | 13      | 14             | 15                  | 16     | 17       |
| 18                  | 19<br>Martin Luther<br>King Jr. Day | 20      | 21<br>Shevat 1 | 22                  | 23     | 24       |
| 25                  | 26                                  | 27      | 28             | 29                  | 30     | 31       |

Born in Poland in 1873, Abraham Neumann pursued art studies in Warsaw, Krakow and Paris early in the 20th century. He subsequently traveled widely — visiting a number of European countries, Palestine (in 1904), and the United States (after World War I). He lived in Palestine for several years in the 1920s, teaching at what became Israel's national school of art, the Bezalel Academy of Arts and Design. Among his paintings from that time is the one on this page of



Jerusalem's Damascus Gate. He painted exceptionally evocative landscapes, many of them informed by his travels, along with still lifes and portraits.

He died in the Krakow ghetto in 1942.

| Shevat - Adar 5775          |                      |         |                  | FEBRUARY 2015            |              |                       |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|---------|------------------|--------------------------|--------------|-----------------------|
| SUNDAY                      | MONDAY               | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY        | THURSDAY                 | FRIDAY       | SATURDAY              |
| 1                           | 2                    | 3       | 4<br>Tu B'Shevat | 5                        | 6            | 7                     |
| 8                           | 9                    | 10      | 11               | 12<br>Lincoln's Birthday | 13           | 14<br>Valentine's Day |
| 15                          | 16<br>Presidents Day | 17      | 18               | 19                       | 20<br>Adar 1 | 21                    |
| 22<br>Washington's Birthday | 23                   | 24      | 25               | 26                       | 27           | 28                    |
|                             |                      |         |                  |                          |              |                       |





Karel Hašler was an enormously popular Czech entertainer — a singer, actor, cabaret performer, movie star, screenwriter, director, and the writer of more than 300 songs. He and his songs were symbols of freedom and resistance; his songs hailed Czech heroes of independence and made fun of Communists. After the Nazi occupation, he wrote songs lyrics that opposed the Germans. He was arrested by the Gestapo in 1941 and deported to the Mauthausen concentration camp, where he died by having cold water poured on him outside during the winter and being left to freeze.

Though he was not well known outside the Czech Republic, he is still well remembered there. In 2013, the Czech band Patrola Šlapeto released a CD and DVD with 23 of his songs, which can be sampled at <http://bit.ly/karelhasek>. A number of his works can be found on YouTube and elsewhere on the Internet — a YouTube search for “Karel Hašler” is a good place to begin.

| Adar - Nisan 5775         |        |         |                 | MARCH 2015 |        |               |
|---------------------------|--------|---------|-----------------|------------|--------|---------------|
| SUNDAY                    | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY       | THURSDAY   | FRIDAY | SATURDAY      |
| 1                         | 2      | 3       | 4<br>Erev Purim | 5<br>Purim | 6      | 7             |
| 8<br>Daylight Time Begins | 9      | 10      | 11              | 12         | 13     | 14            |
| 15                        | 16     | 17      | 18              | 19         | 20     | 21<br>Nisan 1 |
| 22                        | 23     | 24      | 25              | 26         | 27     | 28            |
| 29                        | 30     | 31      |                 |            |        |               |



Viktor Ullmann, whose parents had converted from Judaism to Catholicism years earlier, was born in 1898 in what is today Český Těšín, on the border between the Czech Republic and Poland. He studied in Vienna and then moved to Prague to pursue a career in music. A student of the composer Arnold Schönberg, Ullmann composed classical works, conducted, and was a music critic, among other undertakings. By the late 1920s, his music was being performed widely in Europe, and he subsequently lived and worked in Switzerland and Germany as well as Prague. In the 1930s, his compositions included an opera called *Der Sturz des Antichrist*, which, though not performed during his lifetime, was highly regarded.

Because of his Jewish heritage he was deported to Theresienstadt in 1942, and remarkably, continued to compose prolifically, creating some 23 works — his activities allowed as part of a sanctioned prisoner-administered cultural program. He also played a key role in other aspects of cultural life at the camp. He was transported to Auschwitz in October 1944, where he was killed.

Ullmann's music is widely available on CD, and the one-act opera he wrote at Theresienstadt, *The Emperor of Atlantis*, can be listened to at <http://bit.ly/emperoratlantis>. The Viktor Ullmann Foundation in the UK was created to “honour, celebrate and remember [his] life, courage and genius.”

| Nisan - Iyar 5775  |              |         |           | APRIL 2015                    |                    |                        |
|--------------------|--------------|---------|-----------|-------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------|
| SUNDAY             | MONDAY       | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY                      | FRIDAY             | SATURDAY               |
|                    |              |         | 1         | 2                             | 3<br>Erev Passover | 4<br>Passover 1st Day  |
| 5<br>Easter Sunday | 6            | 7       | 8         | 9                             | 10                 | 11<br>Passover 8th Day |
| 12                 | 13           | 14      | 15        | 16<br>Yom Hashoah             | 17                 | 18                     |
| 19                 | 20<br>Iyar 1 | 21      | 22        | 23<br>Israel Independence Day | 24                 | 25                     |
| 26                 | 27           | 28      | 29        | 30                            |                    |                        |

Born in 1904 in the city of Osnabrück in Germany's Westphalia region, Felix Nussbaum studied in Hamburg and Berlin, developing a distinct and penetrating style with elements of Expressionism, Cubism and Realism. The rise of the Nazis beginning in 1933, and their views on art, had a chilling effect on both Nussbaum and his work. A fire set by the Nazis in his Berlin studio destroyed some 150 of his works, and thereafter much of his work was characterized by

expressions of fear and loneliness. His 1943 "Self Portrait with Jewish Identity Card," shown here, is among his best-known works.

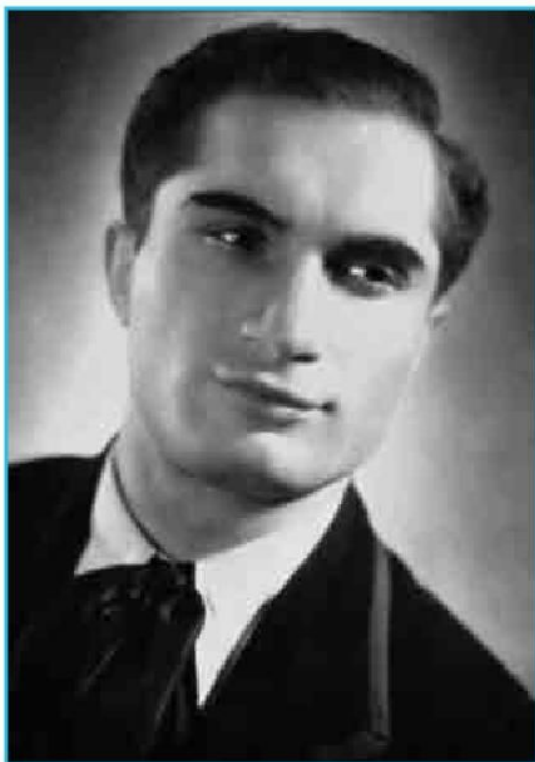


With his wife, the Polish painter Felka Platek, he settled in Belgium, where he was arrested and sent to the Saint-Cyprien detention camp. He escaped and returned to Brussels, where he and his wife remained in hiding until their arrest in 1944. They were deported to Auschwitz and killed.

The Felix Nussbaum Haus was designed by architect Daniel Libeskind and opened in Osnabrück in 1998. It is a museum devoted to Nussbaum's art and memory, housing his surviving works. There is a great deal of information to be found at <http://bit.ly/fnussbaum>.



| Iyar - Sivan 5775              |                    |               |           |                 | MAY 2015 |                    |
|--------------------------------|--------------------|---------------|-----------|-----------------|----------|--------------------|
| SUNDAY                         | MONDAY             | TUESDAY       | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY        | FRIDAY   | SATURDAY           |
|                                |                    |               |           |                 | 1        | 2                  |
| 3                              | 4                  | 5             | 6         | 7<br>Lag B'Omer | 8        | 9                  |
| 10<br>Mother's Day             | 11                 | 12            | 13        | 14              | 15       | 16                 |
| 17                             | 18                 | 19<br>Sivan 1 | 20        | 21              | 22       | 23<br>Erev Shavuot |
| 24<br>Shavuot<br>1st Day<br>31 | 25<br>Memorial Day | 26            | 27        | 28              | 29       | 30                 |



Joseph Schmidt was a renowned tenor, one of the finest of his age, with a technique that sounded effortless and a gleaming upper register. In the words of the writer Neil Kurtzman, “He could do anything, runs, trills, molten beauty and legato — all were his.”

He was born in 1904 to a Jewish family in a village in Austria-Hungary that later was part of Romania and now is in Ukraine. By the late 1920s, he had become wildly popular in Berlin. Although his short stature (he was under 5 feet tall) kept him from making many appearances on the operatic stage, he performed in concerts, recitals and films, and in many countries including the U.S.

Fleeing France, he ended up in a Swiss internment camp for refugees in 1942. Shortly afterwards, at age 38, he suffered a fatal heart attack.

There are many clips of Schmidt’s performances at <http://bit.ly/j-schmidt> and elsewhere, and many of his recordings can be found on CD. He was commemorated in a 2004 German postage stamp that shows the score of his 1933 film *A Song Goes Round the World*.

| Sivan - Tammuz 5775 |        |         |           | JUNE 2015      |        |          |
|---------------------|--------|---------|-----------|----------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY              | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY       | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                     | 1      | 2       | 3         | 4              | 5      | 6        |
| 7                   | 8      | 9       | 10        | 11             | 12     | 13       |
| 14                  | 15     | 16      | 17        | 18<br>Tammuz 1 | 19     | 20       |
| 21<br>Father's Day  | 22     | 23      | 24        | 25             | 26     | 27       |
| 28                  | 29     | 30      |           |                |        |          |



Charlotte Salomon, born to a well-to-do Jewish family in Berlin in 1917, demonstrated prodigious artistic talents early on, and began studies at a prestigious German art university in 1936, despite the extreme difficulties Jews faced in enrolling and pursuing studies. By 1938 attending had become too dangerous, and after Kristallnacht, she went to France to live with her grandparents; her grandmother subsequently committed suicide.

In Nice, working with great intensity, she created an extraordinary series of 769 paintings called *Life? or Theater?*, based on her own life, that of her family, and on the tenor of the times. She envisioned it as a kind of musical play, and included words and notes

about appropriate music to accompany it.

She and her husband were deported to Auschwitz in October 1943, where, five months pregnant, she was killed.

An opera based on her life and writings, with music by Marc-Andre Dalbavie and libretto by Barbara Honigmann, premiered at the Salzburg Festival in July 2014 to enthusiastic reviews. Many hundreds of Salomon's artworks can be seen online at the Jewish Historical Museum in Amsterdam's website, at <http://bit.ly/c-salomon>.

| Tammuz - Av 5775 |        |         |           | JULY 2015 |            |                       |
|------------------|--------|---------|-----------|-----------|------------|-----------------------|
| SUNDAY           | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY  | FRIDAY     | SATURDAY              |
|                  |        |         | 1         | 2         | 3          | 4<br>Independence Day |
| 5                | 6      | 7       | 8         | 9         | 10         | 11                    |
| 12               | 13     | 14      | 15        | 16        | 17<br>Av 1 | 18                    |
| 19               | 20     | 21      | 22        | 23        | 24         | 25                    |
| 26<br>Tisha B'Av | 27     | 28      | 29        | 30        | 31         |                       |



The composer Hans Krása was born in Prague 1899 to a Czech father and a Jewish mother. His musical talent was apparent at an early age. He studied at Prague's German Music Academy and later lived for a time in Paris. His principal musical influences included the composer Alexander



Zemlinsky (with whom he studied), Mahler, Bartok, Schönberg and Stravinsky. His music, including an opera, *Betrothal in a Dream*, is exceptionally melodic and engaging.

In 1942 he was sent by the Nazis to Theresienstadt, where he composed intensely and was very involved with the camp's cultural life (along with Viktor Ullmann). Many of Krása's Theresienstadt scores, unfortunately, did not survive. At Theresienstadt he adapted his prewar children's opera *Brundibár* ("Bumblebee") to the available instruments and voices, and it was performed 55 times at the camp. It continues to be performed today, and a number of recordings of *Brundibár* and others of Krása's works are available on CD and can be heard on YouTube.

Krásá was sent on to Auschwitz and killed in 1944.

| Av - Elul 5775 |        |         |           |          |        |          | AUGUST 2015 |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|----------------|--------|---------|-----------|----------|--------|----------|-------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|
| SUNDAY         | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|                |        |         |           |          |        | 1        |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 2              | 3      | 4       | 5         | 6        | 7      | 8        |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 9              | 10     | 11      | 12        | 13       | 14     | 15       |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 16             | 17     | 18      | 19        | 20       | 21     | 22       |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Elul 1         |        |         |           |          |        |          |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 23             | 24     | 25      | 26        | 27       | 28     | 29       |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 30             | 31     |         |           |          |        |          |             |  |  |  |  |  |  |



The Croatian child actress, singer and dancer Lea Deutsch was born into a Jewish family in Zagreb, then part of Yugoslavia, in 1927. Her whole family was passionately interested in the arts, with artists and musicians as regular guests in their home. Her talent was first noticed by an aunt, and Lea ended up studying at the Croatian National Theater at age 5, gaining larger and larger roles. As her popularity grew, she became known as the “Croatian Shirley Temple,” and was written up in Austrian, German and French newspapers. An operetta, *The Prodigy*, was written for her, and with her friend and fellow child performer Darija Gasteiger, Lea enjoyed huge success in Humperdinck’s *Hansel and Gretel*.

By 1941 she was no longer allowed to perform, and many members of the theatrical community tried to help protect the family. Their efforts were unsuccessful, and in May 1943, Lea, her mother and brother were deported to Auschwitz. Lea died in the railway wagon on the way, and her mother and brother were killed at Auschwitz.

There are many Croatians who still remember her, and in 2010, the Croatian filmmaker Branko Ivanda made a “biopic” called *Lea i Darija* — which can be seen (there are no subtitles) at <http://bit.ly/lea-darija-1> and <http://bit.ly/lea-darija-2>.

| Elul 5775 - Tishri 5776    |                                     |                                  |                  | SEPTEMBER 2015 |        |          |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|----------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY                     | MONDAY                              | TUESDAY                          | WEDNESDAY        | THURSDAY       | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                            |                                     | 1                                | 2                | 3              | 4      | 5        |
| 6                          | 7<br>Labor Day                      | 8                                | 9                | 10             | 11     | 12       |
| 13<br>Erev<br>Rosh Hashana | 14<br>Tishri 1 5776<br>Rosh Hashana | 15<br>Rosh Hashana<br>Second Day | 16               | 17             | 18     | 19       |
| 20                         | 21                                  | 22<br>Erev<br>Yom Kippur         | 23<br>Yom Kippur | 24             | 25     | 26       |
| 27                         | 28<br>Succoth 1st Day               | 29<br>Succoth 2nd Day            | 30               |                |        |          |



Moshe Rynecki was born in 1881 into an observant Jewish family in eastern Poland. He started drawing and painting at a very early age. According to his biography at <http://rynecki.org> (which is the definitive source of information about him), he later told his son: “I simply have to do it. If He wouldn’t want me to paint, I wouldn’t have that tremendous urge and desire to immortalize on paper or canvas what I

see. I simply am a writer of sorts — instead of words, I leave my messages in pictures.”

Studying at the Warsaw Academy of Art and remaining in Warsaw, Rynecki painted what was around him: members of the community, scenes of daily life, and Jewish worship. His moving paintings depict these things vividly and sympathetically.

Aware that the future was highly uncertain, he hid some 800 paintings with friends for safekeeping. Although many are lost, enough survive (in museums in Warsaw and in private collections) for there to be a good opportunity to appreciate the scope of his work. His remarkable great-granddaughter Elizabeth is active in tracing his lost art, and a film documentary called *Chasing Portraits* is being made to show these efforts.

Rynecki was killed in 1943 at the Majdanek concentration camp.

| Tishri - Heshvan 5776 |                 |               |           | OCTOBER 2015 |        |          |
|-----------------------|-----------------|---------------|-----------|--------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY                | MONDAY          | TUESDAY       | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY     | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                       |                 |               |           | 1            | 2      | 3        |
| 4                     | 5               | 6             | 7         | 8            | 9      | 10       |
| Hoshana Rabba         | Shemini Atzeret | Simchat Torah |           |              |        |          |
| 11                    | 12              | 13            | 14        | 15           | 16     | 17       |
|                       | Columbus Day    |               | Heshvan 1 |              |        |          |
| 18                    | 19              | 20            | 21        | 22           | 23     | 24       |
| 25                    | 26              | 27            | 28        | 29           | 30     | 31       |





Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance.

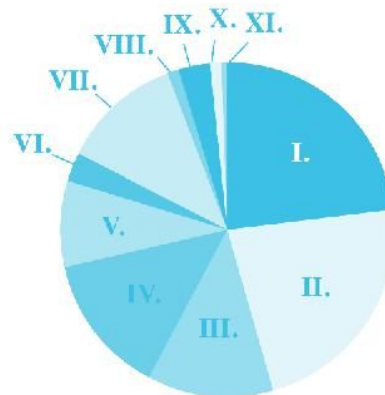
#### Description of Our Programs

The Blue Card provides assistance through the following core programs:

- **Emergency Cash Assistance Program:** provides for survivors' most immediate needs by helping with the cost of medicine, rent, homecare, food and other essentials. The Holocaust Survivor Emergency Cash Assistance Program is funded by the Conference on Jewish Material Claims Against Germany.
- **Dental Care:** named after Curt C. and Else Silberman, provides much needed funding toward dental care, especially in a time of federal budget cuts.
- **Stipend Program:** supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- **Jewish Holiday Program:** provides financial assistance for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- **Summer Vacation Program:** offers an expense-paid summer vacation to needy survivors in the New York area, providing them with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportations, scheduled meals, and a well planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe and group oriented.
- **The Emergency Response Program:** provides an emergency response system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources for installation, service and maintenance. The operator answers in Yiddish, German, Russian, Hungarian or other, and then follows up should there be an emergency.
- **Mazel Tov Birthday Program:** provides survivors with a \$100 check and a card on their birthday.
- **Vitamins Program:** provides Holocaust survivors with multivitamins, minerals and supplements, and liquid meals.
- **Bring a Smile Program:** named after Sonia and Max Lonstein, provides additional support for terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.
- **The Siggie B. Wilzig Fighting Cancer Together Program:** offers aid to Holocaust survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.

In 2013, The Blue Card distributed \$1,870,000 to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; below is a breakdown of that number.

|       |                                  |                    |
|-------|----------------------------------|--------------------|
| I.    | Monthly Stipend                  | \$434,000          |
| II.   | Dental Care                      | \$421,000          |
| III.  | Telephone Emergency Response     | \$230,000          |
| IV.   | Emergency Cash Assistance        | \$253,000          |
| V.    | Jewish Holiday Grant             | \$153,000          |
| VI.   | Birthday Program                 | \$55,000           |
| VII.  | Homecare                         | \$220,000          |
| VIII. | Bring A Smile                    | \$19,000           |
| IX.   | Fighting Cancer Together Program | \$56,000           |
| X.    | Summer Vacation                  | \$21,000           |
| XI.   | Vitamin Program                  | \$8,000            |
|       | <b>Total</b>                     | <b>\$1,870,000</b> |



- **The Blue Card-Lissner Hospital Visitation Program:** offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.
- **The Nutritional Guidance Program:** named after Rita Berkowitz, provides monthly food stipends and nutritional supplements. It also educates participants on proper nutrition.

### Charitable Standing

In 2013, Charity Navigator announced that The Blue Card earned its **ninth consecutive four-star rating** for its ability to deliver services in a cost-effective manner. Fewer than 10% of rated charities have received at least four consecutive four star evaluations, indicating that The Blue Card outperforms most charities in America in its efforts to operate in the most fiscally responsible way possible.

The Blue Card is accredited by the Better Business Bureau's Wise Giving Alliance. In order to meet accreditation standards, The Blue Card demonstrated its compliance with 20 stringent regulations regarding transparency standards and effectiveness reporting. The strictness of the standards ensures that only the most qualified charities are able to maintain their rating.

In 2012 and 2013, The Blue Card was voted one of the Best Jewish Charities by the Federal Times.



# THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

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